

JANUARY 2005

T L DIRECT

The Line Direct

The TLD Chain of Customer Support : The Master Link for our development

Our customers' expectations have significantly changed since the time when they mostly focused on our ability to weld, machine and assemble specific equipment to meet their needs. These expectations have urged us to mature as an organization and to become independently capable of the engineering and development of equipment. From a status of subcontractor/fabricator, we've become engineering companies able to analyze and synthesize the operational requirements of the customer in a competitive way. To reach this goal, we had to rethink our roles and our methods, reinforce our engineering capabilities, optimize our costs and eliminate some tasks that our subcontractors could achieve more efficiently.

Today, we note more often that our customer's needs are focused on a good product well positioned economically but most importantly well supported in the field. In fact, most of our competitors offer good products able to reach the operational needs of the customer. It is therefore very likely that the future belongs to the GSE suppliers able to bring the best Customer Service.

Customer Service is not only the business of the Field Technicians, the Product Support Managers or the Spare Part teams; this is the business of all of us. It is in fact the long Chain of Customer Support that we have to consistently monitor

for effectiveness. One error, one moment of slackening of one individual and the chain is broken and generates an unsatisfied customer, who will then consider giving its business to our competitors.

The engineer must think of the "supportability" of the equipment he is designing, the purchaser must think of the service orientation of the suppliers he selects, the worker has to continuously bring back the suggestions that will improve the "maintainability" of the product, the supervisor needs to know how to mobilize the energies of his team...We are all a part of the long chain of Customer Support

A new reengineering phase of our company has started and our ability to set up the right organization and to mobilize energies, in order to react and solve our customers' issues, is today the key element for the success of this Chain of Support.: Efficient internal communication, technical humility in front of the field reality, improved flexibility, constant contact with the customer (before, during and after the crisis periods), are the assets that will make the difference and will allow us to grow faster than our competitors.

In your function at TLD, think of the small additional plus that you can offer and which will help maintain in good condition the TLD Chain of Customer Support!

Antoine Maguin

The Latest Dispatch

TLD Supplier of the Year 2003 for SWISSPORT International

TLD had the honor to be awarded "The 2003 Supplier of the Year Award" by Swissport International. Here is a picture of the award ceremony which took place in Zurich on Thursday, September 2nd, 2004.



From left to right, Peter LEHMANN, Manager of Global Supply Management of SWISSPORT International, Jean-Marie FULCONIS, Chairman and CEO of TLD, Antoine MAGUIN, TLD COO, Jacques ROUX, Executive VP sale and Service of TLD Europe, Scott GORDON, Executive VP Sales & Service of TLD America with his personal award and Peter STURZENEGGER, Vice President of SWISSPORT International

At this occasion, Scott GORDON also received a special SWISSPORT personal award from Peter STURZENEGGER, to recognize his special customer dedication. Congratulations to Scott and the entire TLD team for their efforts resulting in this prestigious recognition by a global aviation service company!



The Latest Dashboard

T L Dash board (in M€uros)

(Year to date-end of **NOVEMBER** figures)

TLD Sales	2004/11		2004/2003 % Evolution
	in M€uros	in % of total	
GSE - AREA AMERICA (Americas, Australia, Japan, N. Zealand)	28,7	29,2%	25,7%
GSE - AREA EUROPE (Europe, Africa, middle east, India, Pakistan)	36,8	37,4%	27,2%
GSE - AREA ASIA (w/o Taiw an TRVD)	13,7	13,9%	43,4%
Other activities (Adhésives solutions + Taiw an TRVD)	19,2	19,5%	54,7%
TOTAL TLD SALES	98,4	100%	33,4%

TLD Life Digest

TLD Global Customers

The development of customers or prospective customers having important activities throughout the world while having a SINGLE decision-making centre for their procurement of Ground Support Equipment, has led TLD to set up working methods and procedures suited to these multinational clients.

These customers are essential for TLD because they are growing, and their needs for equipment are important. Their activities being worldwide, they often operate on the territories of the 3 TLD sales entities (EUROPE, AMERICA and ASIA) and it is necessary for TLD to speak by only one voice to their decision makers.

Therefore TLD appoints a coordinator for each "global customer", according to the location of the headquarters of this customer. This coordinator is responsible for the direct relation with the customer, in close tie with the other TLD sales entities concerned.

The huge advantage of our TLD organization is that it allows to bring these customers a high level of technical support (service, spare parts) everywhere in the world, with our TLD specialists. This is a guaranty of security for our customers.

Who are our main "global customers" with worldwide operations?

✓ **SWISSPORT** - world largest airport handling Company - whose headquarters are based in ZURICH (the coordinator is thus TLD EUROPE). Recently, an important order was awarded to TLD

for the operation of SWISSPORT in SINGAPORE. The processing of this order is naturally dealt with by TLD ASIA.

✓ **FedEx** whose headquarters are based with MENPHIS (the coordinator is thus TLD AMERICA). TLD delivers TPX 200 MT in the USA but also to Paris CdG (European Hub of FedEx) and in Asia, and these machines are supported by the technical teams of TLD EUROPE and TLD ASIA.

✓ **French group VINCI** with its handling subsidiary company called **WFS** (WORLDWIDE FLIGHT SERVICES) based in CDG, but which has a very important international network.

✓ **AIR FRANCE** which has in Paris CDG, a central purchasing service for all the stations in which AF operates its own equipment.

✓ **AVIAPARTNER** which decides in Brussels its procurement for its important operations in Europe.

✓ **MENZIES AVIATION** which decides from London its purchases for its multinational operations.

✓ **TCR INTERNATIONAL** which buys, from Brussels, the equipment that it will rent in Belgium, in England, in France and in the Netherlands. The development plan of this customer might lead us to sell our equipment on other continents.

TLD has become a prominent partner for these "global customers" and, thanks to its organization, it is considered as a partner exactly meeting their expectations. The contracts already awarded, and the success of their execution, are the fruit of the close cooperation of the teams of TLD EUROPE, AMERICA and ASIA, which respect each other and share a common will to develop our group, and to serve our customers at the best standard.

Denis Bernard

The Last Development of TLD Asia

After a dark year 2003, strongly impacted by the SARS epidemic, and despite the very difficult beginning of 2004, when the airline industry in Asia was still at the stage of recovery, TLD Asia enjoyed very significant order bookings in the last quarter of the year.

Swissport Singapore, the first ground handling operation of Swissport in Asia and China Eastern Airlines represented more than 40% of the bookings. The equipment sold included sixteen pallet/container loaders nine air conditioners and a few 400ppm jet starters as well as ground power units. A good news to share is that an AB-120 apron passenger bus for Menzies Macau was also among the bookings.

While there is a substantial backlog being brought forward, year 2005 would certainly bring significant revenues to TLD Asia, as they are several important equipment acquisition projects throughout ASIA, and TLD is well positioned to be selected as a key supplier for these projects. It is no doubt that TLD Asia has a very good start in 2005, but yet challenges are always in front of us, and one of the new challenges is to introduce the TPX500S towbarless tractor into the Asia market when the A380 aircraft is due to operate in 2006 by the carriers in the region.

Special thanks to all the colleagues in TLD Asia for their continuous efforts and co-operation in achieving the mission of 'REACHING NEW HEIGHTS'.

By the first quarter of 2005, other than those for the ranger products, transfer price will be published for the GSE like Lavatory and Potable Servicing Vehicles; Pallet/Container Dollies and Maintenance Lift Platforms, etc. manufactured by the Shanghai and Taiwan facilities in aiming to providing more sales opportunities for sister sales organizations.

Alex Lam